



John Markus Lervik

Co-Founder & Chief Strategy Officer

\$170M+ (2025)

Revenue

Oslo

HQ

01 Who You're Meeting

John Markus Lervik — Co-Founder & Chief Strategy Officer, Cognite.

In role: Co-founded Cognite in 2016 and was CEO until 2022; Chief Strategy & Development Officer since

Today: High-impact business opportunities for Cognite, and a leading position across other software investments within Aker ASA, Cognite's majority shareholder, building an industrial software ecosystem around the company.

One of Norway's most significant technology entrepreneurs, and this is his third company. He co-founded and led Fast Search & Transfer, acquired by Microsoft in 2008 for \$1.2B, then founded cXense, focused on AI-driven personalisation. He founded Cognite in 2016 and built it into Norway's first unicorn, establishing its position in industrial software around Cognite Data Fusion and the idea of scalable data contextualisation for industry. He holds a doctorate.

Career: Co-Founder & Chief Strategy & Development Officer, Cognite; Co-Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Cognite; Founder, cXense; Co-Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Fast Search & Transfer (acquired by Microsoft, 2008, for \$1.2B)

Education: Doctorate (PhD)

The company: The clearest signal of where this market is heading: an independent industrial-AI platform just sold to a strategic incumbent (Schneider Electric) for 18x revenue, consolidating into AVEVA.

What they sell: Cognite Data Fusion (unified industrial data model + knowledge graph) and Atlas AI (generative/agentic AI for industrial workflows), covering plant operations, asset management and engineering.

02 Where The Company Sits

Closest comparable to Sand on the digital-twin/industrial-data angle specifically. Its \$3.1B exit is the reference point for what a well-executed independent player in this space can be worth.

03 Talking Points

- Three companies, one \$1.2B exit — he thinks in terms of category creation, and the data contextualisation thesis is his.
- His Aker ASA role gives him visibility across an industrial software portfolio; potentially useful well beyond Cognite itself.
- The right counterpart for a strategic or architectural conversation; Rishi for commercial.

What to pressure-test about the company:

- About to lose independence entirely — folding into AVEVA under Schneider Electric, with integration risk for customers and staff
- Glassdoor sample size is thin (169 reviews) for a company this size, limiting confidence in the 3.2 rating
- Post-acquisition roadmap and brand continuity are open questions as of the deal announcement

04 GIP Context

GIP: No connection found. Cognite's investor base (Aker ASA, TCV, Accel, Saudi Aramco) has no disclosed GIP tie, and no GIP portfolio company appears among its named customers (Aker BP and others).

BlackRock: No direct stake in Cognite today. Indirect exposure is coming: once Schneider Electric's ~\$3.1B acquisition of Cognite closes, Cognite becomes part of a company where BlackRock is the largest shareholder (7.93% of Schneider Electric, per...)

Others at Cognite: Girish Rishi (Chairman & Chief Executive Officer); Geir Engdahl (Co-Founder & Chief Technology Officer, AI)

www.cognite.com · [Cognite leadership announcement](#) · [Businesswire release](#) · [Company LinkedIn](#)

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